

DELHI | With a Little Help from Friends

When Prime Minister Manmohan Singh's wife Gursharan Kaur launched the *INS Arihant* in Visakhapatnam, it gave India its first nuclear submarine. The prime minister, Defence Minister A.K. Antony and Navy chief Admiral Sureesh Mehta thanked the over 100 Russian submarine technicians and designers present at the occasion for their cooperation in building the nuclear submarine.

Though indigenous, the submarine still has a heavy Russian component and the assistance extends far more than the submarine's basic design—a Charlie-class hull redesigned to look like a scaled-down dead ringer for Russia's newest Borey-class ballistic missile submarine. The Russians also helped in building the all-important nuclear reactor which gives the vessel limitless underwater capability. All this was done under secret inter-governmen-



KAUR LAUNCHES INDIA'S FIRST NUCLEAR SUBMARINE

tal agreements, which contain none of the intrusive clauses that the United States applies under the End User Monitoring Agreement for even conventional military platforms like fighter aircraft and radars. The only agreement was for total Soviet-style secrecy. It is not clear if banning cameras and recording devices at the media event was a fallout of this agreement.

by Sandeep Unnithan

Best Man

When Karnataka Chief Secretary Sudhakar Rao takes charge as president of the External Affairs Spouses' Association after his wife Nirupama Rao takes over as foreign secretary, it'll be the first time a male IAS officer will head the hitherto wives' only club.



MUFTI IN THE STATE ASSEMBLY

SRINAGAR | Mike Melee

In the first incident of its kind in the state legislature, People's Democratic Party (PDP) President Mehbooba Mufti threw away the Speaker's microphone on the first day of the budget session. She was demanding a debate on the Shopian case. An enraged Speaker M.A. Lone had the PDP leaders "dragged out". Unrepentant, she accused the ruling National Conference of "transforming the House into a municipal body". Chief Minister Omar Abdullah chose to criticise her in a parliamentary manner. "You cannot win elections or hearts of the people by disturbing proceedings, riding on desks and snatching mike and papers from the Speaker," he said.

by Aljaz Hussain

BANGALORE | White Wash

When brothers—and both cabinet ministers to boot—Janardhana and Karunakara Reddy installed Somashekara as the chairman of Karnataka Milk Federation (KMF) on July 26, it was a move to get the BJP a steadfast votebank. The powerful post had been firmly held by former prime minister H.D. Deve Gowda's son and ex-minister H.D. Revanna for 15 years. In January, the BJP launched a milk producers cell ahead of the takeover plan. The KMF is an apex body of 11,000

B.K. RAMESH



THE REDDY BROTHERS

dairies cooperatives comprising two million dairy farmers who distribute three million litres of milk every day. Somashekara, MLA from Bellary, says his first priority will be "the welfare of milk farmers in the state; there is no time for vindictive politics". From lording over mining to taking over a milk federation seems to be just a gulp for the Reddy boys.

by Stephen David